Akshaya Ranganath

Centre for Advanced Financial Research and Learning (CAFRAL),
Reserve Bank of India (RBI),
Prabhadevi,
Mumbai, Maharashtra, India

Personal Website
akshaya.ranganath@cafral.org.in

Education

Pennsylvania State University — State College, PA, USA
M.A. in Economics — 2022 – 2024

SK Somaiya University — Mumbai, India
Diploma in Economics — 2021 – 2022

SIES College, University of Mumbai — Mumbai, India
B.A. in Economics — 2017 – 2020

Research Experience

CAFRAL, Reserve Bank of India — Mumbai, India
Research Associate — June 2025 – Present
Supervisors: Dr. Sankalp Mathur and Dr. Shreya Bhattacharya

Pennsylvania State University — State College, USA
Research Assistant — Aug 2023 - Dec 2023
Supervisor: Dr. Kala Krishna

Pennsylvania State University — State College, USA
Research Assistant — May 2023 - Aug 2023
Supervisor: Dr. Michael Gechter

Research Projects

Are Exporting Firms More Productive? — *Working*

Income Support and Health in Old Age: Evidence from a Pension Reform in India — *Work in Progress*
with Dr. Shreya Bhattacharya and Dr. Arpita Chakravorty

The Effect of Incarceration and Size of Police Force on Crime Rates: Evidence from Firefighters
Supervisor: Dr. Karl Schurter

Dynamic Panel Analysis of Total Factor Productivity: Evidence from Columbia
Supervisor: Dr. Karl Schurter

Policy Reports

Beyond Access: Building a Vulnerability index Matrix (VIM) — *Submitted*
with Dr. Natasha Jha and Dr. Shreya Bhattacharya

Financial Inclusion and Development Department (FIDD), Reserve Bank of India (RBI)

Articles in Popular Media

Evolution of Pension Reforms in India *The Hindu, 8th December, 2025*

with Dr. Shreya Bhattacharya

Social Impact and Leadership Activities

Founded a Rotaract Club under Rotaract International, growing it to a 120+ member community over 6 years of voluntary service across 7 leadership postings.

Led over 40 members managing cultural events, budgeting, and schedules; taught SAT English grammar to Grade 9–10 students.

Notable Leadership Roles

- **President:** Managed a core team of 7 and board of 15; led 100+ members and addressed audiences of 200+.
- **Zonal Rotaract Representative:** Advised 32 clubs (1,100+ members), managing cultural events and inter-collegiate communication.
- **Human Resource Development Director:** Designed and executed training sessions for 110 clubs and district board members (7,500 members).
- **Secretary & Sergeant-at-Arms / Advisor:** Managed bureaucratic documentation, timeline tracking in Excel, annual reporting, and high-pressure conflict resolution.

Key Projects Initiated and Led

- **Joy of Giving:** Directed donation drives serving a village population of 700+; managed logistics, advertisement, and stakeholder relations.
- **Prayas:** Chaired a school redevelopment project; coordinated vendors, stakeholder grant applications, and infrastructure upgrades for underprivileged students.
- **Shiksha:** Launched a free year-round education initiative serving 30+ students annually; secured Rotary Club funding and resources.
- **Rangeela:** Coordinated a school transformation project featuring educational wall designs created by volunteer artists.